



De La Salle University – Dasmariñas

ETHICS REVIEW COMMITTEE

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INFORMED CONSENT (ENGLISH VERSION)

Title of the Study	S-CORE Management System for the Strategic Communications Office of the De La Salle University - Dasmariñas
Name of Principal Investigator	John Emanuelle Arellado Caryl Joy Cabrera Jian Marie Hilario
Name of Organization	Bachelor of Science in Information Technology Student Researchers
Date Submitted	July 2025

This informed consent form has two parts: (1) Information Details (information about the study and the details of participation), and (2) Certificate of Consent (certification that the participants were given the information about the study). The informed consent form will be translated to Filipino version. Each participant will be given copies after the researcher discussed all pertinent information.

PART I: INFORMATION SHEET

INTRODUCTION

Greetings to all, we are John Emanuelle Arellado, Caryl Joy Cabrera, and Jian Marie Hilario, students of the Bachelor of Science in Information Technology with Specialization in Web Development at the College of Information and Computer Studies (CICS) of the De La Salle University-Dasmariñas (DLSU-D). We are currently conducting a capstone project in collaboration with the Strategic Communications Office (SCO) of DLSU-D, the institutional office responsible for managing the university's branding and publicity.

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Our project, entitled “S-CORE Management System for Strategic Communications Office of the De La Salle University - Dasmariñas,” aims to develop a web-based request approval and management system to improve the efficiency of SCO’s workflows and service request handling. You are being invited to participate in this research. Your participation is entirely voluntary, and you are free to take time to decide whether or not you wish to be involved. If there are any terms or concepts that are unclear, we will gladly explain them in detail. You may also ask questions at any point during the process. Your insights and feedback will be invaluable to the success of our study, and we greatly appreciate your consideration.

PURPOSE OF THE RESEARCH

The purpose of this study is to find out how a web-based system can help improve the daily operations of the Strategic Communications Office (SCO) at De La Salle University-Dasmariñas. The SCO receives many requests from different offices, student organizations, and other departments in the university, such as requests for social media posts, graphic designs, event coverage, and publicity materials. Currently, these requests are sent through email or chat, which can be hard to manage and track. This sometimes leads to delays, confusion, or missed tasks. Through this study, we aim to explore whether a web-based system can make it easier for the SCO to receive, organize, and respond to requests more efficiently. We also want to see if the system can help requestors track the progress of their requests, reduce errors, and improve communication between the SCO and

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the people it serves. The system will also include features like automated reports, task assignments, and real-time updates to help the SCO work more smoothly and transparently. Overall, this research hopes to support the SCO in delivering better services and maintaining the university's strong and consistent image.

TYPE OF RESEARCH INTERVENTION

In this study, the proponents will conduct a research intervention that involves the testing of the developed S-CORE web-based request approval and management system, followed by the administration of a survey questionnaire and one-on-one interviews to evaluate its effectiveness and usability.

The testing phase will be carried out with selected participants from the Strategic Communications Office (SCO) and requestors who regularly interact with the office. After the system has been developed and deployed, participants will be asked to perform actual tasks within the system, such as submitting requests, tracking approvals, and managing tasks. This will allow the researchers to observe how the system performs in a real-use scenario and identify any usability issues or workflow improvements.

Following the system testing, the proponents will conduct ten (10) one-on-one interviews and a survey that requires ninety (90) respondents, each expected to take approximately 10 to 20 minutes per participant. The interviews will be conducted either onsite in one of the enclosed

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rooms at DLSU-D or online via Microsoft Teams, depending on the time availability of both the researchers and the participants. The survey will be administered online through Google Forms during the data-gathering phase of the capstone, after the system has been developed. The participants will include selected staff of the Strategic Communications Office (SCO) as well as requestors from institutional offices and student organizations who regularly interact with the office.

The goal of these interviews and surveys is to gather insights into how the current request and workflow processes are being handled from both the internal (SCO staff) and external (requestor) perspectives. This includes understanding the challenges, inefficiencies, and communication gaps experienced in the current system.

The information gathered will help the proponents design and refine the S-CORE web-based request approval and management system to ensure it is tailored to the actual needs of the SCO and its stakeholders. By incorporating feedback from both the service providers and the users, the system can be developed to enhance daily operations, improve coordination, and deliver a more efficient and user-friendly service experience.

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PARTICIPANT SELECTION

You have been selected to participate in this study as either a member of the Strategic Communications Office (SCO) or a student/faculty/staff who regularly works with the office. Your direct involvement in submitting, processing, or managing requests provides valuable insight into the current workflows and communication processes within the SCO. Whether you are part of the team handling requests or someone who submits them, your experience is essential in identifying strengths, challenges, and areas for improvement. By sharing your feedback through this questionnaire, you will help shape the development of S-CORE—a web-based request approval and management system designed to enhance efficiency, transparency, and collaboration across all stakeholders.

VOLUNTARY PARTICIPATION

Your participation in this research is entirely voluntary. You are free to decide whether or not you would like to take part in this study. If you choose not to participate, it will not affect your relationship with the researchers, the Strategic Communications Office, or De La Salle University - Dasmariñas in any way. You will continue to receive the same services and support as usual. If you agree to participate but later change your mind, you may withdraw at any time. If you have already shared information, you may also request that your responses not be included in the study. Your decision will be respected without any consequences.

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PROCEDURES

In this study, you will first participate by using and testing the developed S-CORE request approval and management system for the Strategic Communications Office (SCO). After interacting with the system and performing tasks such as submitting requests, tracking approvals, and managing tasks, you will provide your insights and experiences through a structured interview or survey designed to evaluate the system's effectiveness. The purpose of this interview or survey is to assess the system's effectiveness in enhancing workflow efficiency, communication, and service delivery within the SCO. You may complete the interview either online via Microsoft Teams or onsite at the DLSU-D grounds. On the other hand, you may complete the survey either online via Google Forms or on paper, depending on your preference and convenience.

The questionnaire is organized according to the ISO/IEC 25010:2023 software quality model, which includes eight (8) key areas: Functional Suitability, Performance Efficiency, Compatibility, Usability, Reliability, Security, Maintainability and Portability. These categories are essential in determining how well the system supports SCO operations and meets the needs of both requestors and SCO staff. The questions will evaluate the system's usability, reliability, adaptability, and overall performance. The interview and survey will both have open and closed-ended questions that's primarily about your insights and opinions on how we can improve the processes of the SCO. You may answer the survey by yourself,

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or it can be read to you and you can answer aloud while your answer is being written down by one of the research proponents.

The interview and survey will be administered either onsite or online by the research proponents: John Emanuelle Arellado, Caryl Joy Cabrera, and Jian Marie Hilario. The schedule will be based on the availability of the researchers and participants. If onsite, it will be conducted at one of the study rooms in DLSU-D Grounds. If online, it will be conducted via Microsoft Teams. Your interview and questionnaire response will be recorded and remain confidential. Your name will not appear on any part of the paper, and a code number will be used to protect your identity. Only the designated members of the research team will be present to your interview (unless you would like someone else to be there with you) and have access to your data, which will be used solely for the improvement of the S-CORE system. If there are any questions you do not feel comfortable answering, you are free to skip them or inform the proponents. Your comfort, privacy, and honest feedback are highly valued throughout this process.

DURATION

Your participation in this research will involve completing a system evaluation questionnaire consisting of approximately 15 statements. These statements are designed to assess the proposed S-CORE Request Approval and Management System based on the ISO/IEC 25010:2023 software quality model. The questionnaire covers eight (8) key areas: Functional

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Suitability, Performance Efficiency, Compatibility, Usability, Reliability, Security, Maintainability and Portability.

It is expected to take around 10 to 15 minutes to complete the questionnaire and another 10 to 15 minutes to test the system. There are no follow-up requirements after submission, and your participation is limited to this single instance of data collection. The research proponents greatly appreciate the time and effort you dedicate to providing your feedback, as it plays a crucial role in refining and improving the S-CORE system to better serve the needs of the Strategic Communications Office and its stakeholders.

RISKS/DISCOMFORT

The risks associated with participating in this research are minimal. The only possible discomfort may come from answering certain questions in the System Evaluation Questionnaire, such as feeling unsure about how to respond, being hesitant to give negative feedback, or experiencing slight fatigue when completing the survey. If this happens, participants will be encouraged to answer to the best of their ability and may request clarification from the researchers if needed. They may also take short breaks during the process to reduce fatigue or discomfort. The questionnaire is solely intended to gather feedback on the functionality, interaction capability, and flexibility of the proposed S-CORE request approval and management system for the Strategic Communications Office (SCO). As such, no sensitive or personally identifiable information will be collected. The

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questionnaire is designed to evaluate the system's performance based on your experience and perspective as a user. However, if at any point you feel uncomfortable answering a particular question, you are not required to respond. You may skip any item or discontinue your participation at any time without any consequences.

Your comfort and privacy are important to us. All responses will be kept strictly confidential and will be used exclusively for the purpose of improving the S-CORE system.

BENEFITS

By participating in this research, you will contribute to the development of a web-based system specifically designed to improve how the Strategic Communications Office (SCO) manages and responds to service and approval requests. Your feedback will help ensure that the system is efficient, user-friendly, and aligned with the actual needs of its users.

For the DLSU-D community, this project aims to streamline communication, reduce delays, and enhance the overall quality of services provided by the SCO. In the long term, the system may also serve as a model for other departments or institutions seeking to improve their own request and workflow management processes, contributing to broader improvements in organizational efficiency and digital transformation.

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REIMBURSEMENTS

While we sincerely value your participation in this study, please note that you will not receive any form of monetary payment for your involvement. However, as a token of appreciation, interview participants will receive a snack during or after the interview, while survey respondents will have a chance to win Php 200 through a raffle draw after the data-gathering phase of the system, in which five (5) winners will be selected at random. The winners will be contacted via Microsoft Outlook or Microsoft Teams to claim their prize.

CONFIDENTIALITY

Your privacy is a top priority in this study. All information you provide through the System Evaluation Questionnaire will be treated with strict confidentiality. Only the research proponents will have access to your responses. Your name will not appear on any documents or reports; instead, a code will be assigned to ensure your anonymity.

All data collected will be securely stored in password-protected digital files, accessible only to the research team. Once the study is completed and the results have been analyzed, the data will be archived in a way that prevents identification of individual participants. After the research concludes, all raw data including questionnaire responses will be permanently deleted to protect your privacy.

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Although this study does not involve highly sensitive or personal topics, we recognize that participation may still raise concerns about being identified. While your involvement in the study may be known to others, no specific responses or personal details will ever be disclosed. If at any point you feel uncomfortable or have concerns about confidentiality, you are encouraged to reach out to the researchers. Your participation is entirely voluntary, and your comfort, trust, and honest feedback are greatly valued.

SHARING THE RESULTS

The findings from this research will be analyzed and compiled to assess the effectiveness of the web-based request approval and management system developed for the Strategic Communications Office (SCO). These results will be presented in various formats, such as internal reports, capstone documentation, and academic or research presentations.

A summary of the results will be made available to participants upon request. Additionally, the research outcomes may be shared at academic conferences or published in relevant journals or university platforms. While your individual responses will remain confidential, the overall findings may be discussed in these broader settings to contribute to the improvement of similar systems in other institutions.

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If you are interested in receiving a copy of the summary report or would like to learn more about the results of the study, please feel free to let us know via Microsoft Outlook (ccd0231@dlsud.edu.ph), and we will gladly provide the information.

RIGHT TO REFUSE OR WITHDRAW

Participation in this research is entirely voluntary. You have the right to refuse to take part or to withdraw from the study at any time, without any negative consequences or impact on your current or future relationship with the researchers, the Strategic Communications Office, or De La Salle University-Dasmariñas. If you choose to participate in an interview, you will also have the opportunity to review your responses and request that any part or all of your input be removed from the study. You are not required to answer any question that makes you feel uncomfortable, and you may stop participating at any point without needing to provide a reason. Your comfort, autonomy, and decision will always be respected.

WHO TO CONTACT

If you have any questions or concerns about this study, please contact:

Caryl Joy D. Cabrera

Researcher

Phone Number: +63 906 435 8811

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Email Address: ccd0231@dlsud.edu.ph

College of Information and Computer Studies - De La Salle University - Dasmariñas

DISCLOSURE STATEMENT

[No potential conflict of interest was reported by the author.]

This provides the details that the primary investigator (PI) has no potential conflict of interest.

[] I declare that there is no conflict of professional interest incurred in the commencement of this research.

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PART II: CERTIFICATE OF CONSENT

I have read the entire information sheet (or have been read to me) and I voluntarily agree to participate in the study. I had enough time to ask further questions about the possible benefits and consequences of joining in the study and all had been answered to my satisfaction. I also understand that I may ask additional questions at any time. Further, I understand that I have the right to withdraw at any moment in this survey without justifying my decision to do so and without affecting my medical care.

Respondent Code Number:

Name of Participant	Signature of Participant	Date of Signature
Name of Witness	Signature of Witness	Date of Signature

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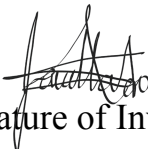


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I certify that I have completely explained to the above individual the nature and purpose of the survey, potential benefits and disagreeable discomforts in participating. Also, I have answered all the participant's questions and concerns and have witnessed the above signature.

John Emmanuelle Arellado
Name of Investigator


Signature of Investigator

Date of Signature

Caryl Joy Cabrera
Name of Investigator


Signature of Investigator

Date of Signature

Jian Marie Hilario
Name of Investigator


Signature of Investigator

Date of Signature

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